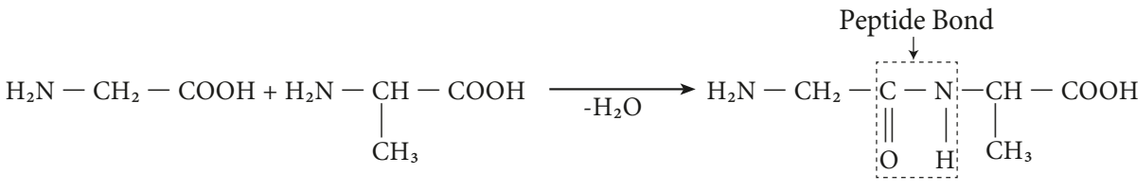
more number of amino acids linked this way you get a polypeptide. If the number of amino acids are less it is called as a polypeptide, if it has large number of amino acids (and preferably has a function) then it is called a protein.



The amino end of the peptide is known as N-terminal or amino terminal while the carboxy end is called C-terminal or carboxy terminal. In general protein sequences are written from N-Terminal to C-Terminal. The atoms other than the side chains (R-groups) are called main chain or the back bone of the polypeptide.

14.2.5 Classification of proteins

Proteins are classified based on their structure (overall shape) into two major types. They are fibrous proteins and globular proteins.

Fibrous proteins

Fibrous proteins are linear molecules similar to fibres. These are generally insoluble in water and are held together by disulphide bridges and weak intermolecular hydrogen bonds. The proteins are often used as structural proteins. Example: Keratin, Collagen etc…

Globular proteins

Globular proteins have an overall spherical shape. The polypeptide chain is folded into a spherical shape. These proteins are usually soluble in water and have many functions including catalysis (enzyme). Example: myoglobin, insuline

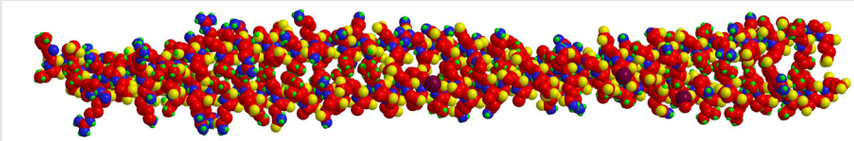


Figure 14.15 (a) Structure of fibrous proteins

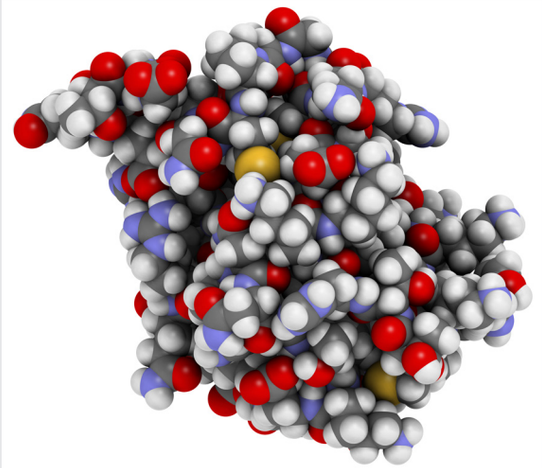


Figure 14.15 (b) Structure of globular proteins

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